

Evidence-Quality Scoring Rubric

A transparent internal screening framework developed for this evidence audit. It is not an internationally validated scale. Equal weights are used for the four evidence-quality dimensions as a practical screening choice, not as a claim that the dimensions are intrinsically equivalent.

Evidence quality: (Recency + Geographic Specificity + Method Strength + Actionability) / 4. Openness is reported separately: (Public Accessibility + Reusability) / 2. Total scores are retained for transparency; classifications use the unrounded evidence-quality score.

Score anchors

Criterion	1 = weak	3 = moderate	5 = strong
Recency	Before 2012	2017-2020	2024-2026
Geographic specificity	National or general	Dire Dawa city or administration	Named kebele, neighbourhood, catchment, or facility
Method strength	Unclear method or unsupported description	Structured case study, review, or clearly described qualitative study	Peer-reviewed study or official dataset with documented design, sampling, or validation
Actionability	Background only	Helps define a problem or validation question	Directly supports a specific planning or validation decision
Public accessibility	Not accessible or summary only	Public PDF or readable public documentation	Open downloadable data or documentation with clear reuse
Reusability	Rights or restrictions unclear	Citation permitted but reuse conditions limited or unclear	Clear open license and downloadable machine-readable material

Quality bands

Strong evidence for planning use: score ≥ 4.0 . Useful but requires qualification: score ≥ 3.0 and < 4.0 . Contextual evidence: score ≥ 2.0 and < 3.0 . Background only: score < 2.0 . Bands are applied to the unrounded score; displayed scores are rounded to two decimals.

Sensitivity check

A sensitivity score doubles the weights for geographic specificity and method strength: (Recency + 2 x Geography + 2 x Method + Actionability) / 6. No source changes quality band under this alternative weighting, so the classification is robust for these six included sources.

Interpretation limits

A high quality score does not prove current operational readiness. Historical evidence, technical models, plans, and operational records remain distinct evidence types. Openness is not evidence quality: a restricted dataset can be methodologically strong while being difficult to reuse.